

VertiGO!!!



Newsletter of the New Zealand Alpine Club, Wellington Section

NO. 729 JULY 2010, PO BOX 1628 WELLINGTON



Nearing their high point on Tapuae-o-Uenuku
Photo courtesy of Max Gough

Club nights are at Turnbull House, on the first unimpeded Monday of every month. New and prospective members are welcome. Meetings and talks start at 8.00 pm with club business and tea & coffee afterwards. Meet for dinner at the Backbencher public bar at 6.30 pm and on to Turnbull House at 7.30 pm for a catch up.



Next section night: 5 July 2010

Paul Knott – CMC Mountaineer of the Year 2009



Paul has been exploring, rock climbing, and mountaineering for 20 years now. His achievements were finally recognised with the award of Mountaineer of the Year from the Canterbury Mountaineering Club earlier this year.

At this month's club meeting Paul will be touching on his early exploratory rock climbing and mountaineering experiences in places such as Siberia, Kyrgyzstan, Oman, and Morocco before moving on in more detail to a recent trip he made to southeast Alaska and the Yukon exploring the southern end of the Fairweather range.

"I was inspired to climb there by the presence of soaring unclimbed arêtes in this remote wilderness, and became even more determined when I realised that the main Johns Hopkins glacier in centre of the range was completely unvisited by climbers. I was lucky to persuade Guy McKinnon to join me in the endeavour and share in the risk of spending most of a month in storm-bound tents. The talk will explain how we gained access to the glacier, what we climbed, and what we didn't climb. The trip was supported financially by the Mount Everest Foundation."



TRIP REPORTS

Please send your trip reports to newsletter@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz, so everyone can enjoy your stories.

Winter warm-up on Tapuae-o-Uenuku, 4-6 June 2010

With Queen's Birthday fast approaching, it looked like the traditional first play in the winter snow was on the cards. Last year the lack of a 4WD had scuppered our plans to get into the south side of Tapuae-o-Uenuku through Bluff Station, resulting in a last minute diversion to Nelson Lakes. This time we were better prepared courtesy of Dave and his highly practical 4x4 Delica, and come 3am on Friday morning the four of us were aboard the Bluebridge and on our way.

A week and a half of the season's first southerly storms had given the southeasterly aspects of the Kaikouras a good pasting, and we were expecting nothing less than fresh snow up to our eyeballs. Hopefully the windward slopes would have deloaded naturally before our arrival, but one of the cool things about visiting places like this is that there's no beta on conditions - you don't know what you're going to find until you get there. The drive from Kekerengu to Branch is a couple of hours under favourable summer conditions, but due to the recent rainfall we spent a good hour or more collapsing banks, moving boulders and preparing stream crossings for the Delica. Luckily we had the skills of two roading engineers - Dave and Matt - on our team, not to mention the dirty great shovel and crowbar lent to us by Hamish from Bluff Station.



Tapuae-o-Uenuku from the northeast on the drive in
Photo courtesy of Max Gough

Leaving the vehicle at the airstrip, the approach to the eastern basins was pretty cruisey and followed a ground track for much of the way. A loosely cairned traverse across scree slopes and a short section of bluffy ground led to more scree (this time frozen), and an obvious campsite around the snowline at 1500m, complete with stone wall and antlers for decoration.

We made a fairly casual start in the morning, being on our way shortly before dawn, and early on made the decision to stick together as a group of four and attempt to summit together by the normal route. I had planned the trip with half an eye on an attempt on the south face, but it didn't take long to see that anything steep was in typical early season condition, with the only promising gut up to the south ridge being incomplete and copping constant spindrift avalanches. Also, disappointingly, the south face itself didn't reveal any obvious aesthetic lines. Ah well, I guess that's what a recce is for.



Panorama of the Seaward Kaikouras and Pacific coast
Photo courtesy of Max Gough

The fresh snow had had little chance to consolidate in the low temperatures, and made for slow going as we postholed up the first slope. From the upper basin (which would make a good high camp if you could be bothered to walk in that far on the first day), a steadily angled couloir tops out at the saddle where the route converges with that from the Hodder valley. On the saddle the nor'wester was howling, and we got hammered by the last week's wind-deposited snow being returned with interest to the other side of the mountain. The wind made it impossible to stay on the crest of the ridge, and although traversing the wind slab on the northern side made for easier travel, none of it had run naturally yet and I sensed we were asking to be taken for a ride into the Hodder. Around 80 vertical metres below the summit we took some photos, declared ourselves satisfied with the view, and decided to pull the pin. 2800m on a mountain in winter and hadn't even needed to put our crampons on, which was a slightly bizarre feeling. Nobody was too fussed about not reaching the top - for Robin this was the first mountaineering of any kind she'd done and she was pretty stoked. The descent provided an opportunity for various shovel-assisted glissade attempts, and we were back at the tents shortly before dusk.

Midway through the night the rain started, and the walk out on Sunday morning gave us time to wonder whether we'd be able to get the truck out through the two more major stream crossings. My gamble to save 600g by not carrying a waterproof shell came back to bite me in the arse, and arriving at the Delica after four hours my lovely winter softshell was pretty well wringing wet. At least I was warm I suppose.

Crossing Dee Stream was fairly exciting. If we hadn't come in the same way there's no way we'd have risked it, but as it was we spotted the line and managed to avoid getting the truck swept away. Another hour or two and it might have been a different story.

Pitching up at the Store at Kekerengu I managed to phone and change our ferry from Monday to Sunday evening. Important business out of the way, we spent the rest of the afternoon eating chowder and cake, drinking coffee and sitting by the fire, interspersed with the odd spell of beach cricket. A most civilised way to end the trip. Big thanks to Hamish Murray of Bluff Station for all his assistance in planning the trip, and for granting us passage across his land to the Branch airstrip for the very reasonable sum of \$75.

Trip members: Robin Friesen, Max Gough, Dave Howard, Matt Turnbull



Checking for cell phone reception halfway up Tapuae-o-Uenuku
Photo courtesy of Max Gough

2010 Wellington Section photo competition

This year's photo competition saw a panel of four judges (John Rhodes, Shaun Barnett, Andy Reisinger and Matt Evans) select their favourite shots, with the audience choosing the final winners.

This year's photo competition was sponsored by:



A selection of the winners on the night are presented below.



Overall winner: John Palmer, Three finger exercises



Photo journalism: Hannah McGregor, Night navigation



Alpine general winner: Brad Markle, Glacier stream



Alpine nature: Andy Maloney, Pleurophyllum



Humour: Derek Cheng, Tiny girlfriend



UPCOMING CLUB TRIPS



Wellington Section Trips

Trips are a key part of the Wellington Section. Trips can be of any length, any level of difficulty, and any size. Simply email us or approach us at the monthly meeting, and we can help you get going. Send your trip ideas, no matter how vague, to trips@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz



Ruapehu South

Date: 9-11 July 2010

Leader: Adam Power

Level: AIC Graduate and 0-3 years experience

On Friday night we will drive up to Ohakune and either tent near the mountain road or stay at the backpackers. Saturday we will ascend the highest point on Ruapehu = Taurangi peak (2797m) returning for a pub meal at the Powderhorn in the evening. On Sunday we will attempt Girdlestone (2658m), the outlying peak on the right of Taurangi by crossing the Mangaehuehu Glacier. Contact Adam at poweradam@myvuw.ac.nz, ph 021 0269 8151 or on 04 236 5494



Ruapehu North - Te Heu Heu, Dome, and Paretetaitonga

Date: 13-15 August 2010

Leader: Peter Ellis

Level: AIC Graduate and 0-3 years experience

The plan is to drive up to Whakapapa, and climb up to Delta Corner Hut on Friday night. On Saturday we will stroll up to the crater, inspect the Dome shelter (2672m) and attempt Paratetaitonga (2751m), returning to Delta Corner for the evening. On Sunday we will return to the crater and attempt Te Heu Heu (2732m) along the main ridge, descending the skifield to the car park and home thereafter. Contact Peter at 021 934 482 (evenings) or email me at ellis@netspeed.com.au



Mt Taranaki / Egmont

Date: 10-12 September 2010

Leader: TBA

Level: AIC Graduate and 0-3 years experience

On Friday night we will drive up to Taranaki and walk in for 2h to Tahurangi Lodge. Saturday we will ascend to the crater and then summit of Taranaki. Those who are especially adventurous might like to have a go at Sharks Tooth. Sunday may involve a jaunt to Humpries Castle or the Organ Pipes for a bit of rock climbing. Contact Kevin at 934 0975 (evenings) or email me at kp@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz.



Wellington Section Funding Contribution to the Unwin Project



The NZAC (the Club) has over the last five years committed itself to the refurbishment of Unwin Lodge. It has over the last 2 – 3 years already invested about \$230,000 into the redevelopment of the Warden's Quarters and the Main Common Room. The project has now reached the point where it needs to commence the re-build of the Bunkrooms at a further cost of \$600,000.

This is posing a significant fund raising challenge for the Club however the Club believes that the challenge can be met.

As part of this challenge all the Sections of the NZAC are now being asked by the Club to contribute funds to the Unwin Project either by way of donations or as loans. It is hoped that all Section contributions to the project can be secured before September 2010.

The Club's huge commitment to Unwin Lodge is based on the following strategic goals:

- The club has strong historical connections with the Mt Cook and its climbing heritage.
- The club is committed to providing base lodge accommodation at Mt Cook.
- Unwin itself has long been regarded as the flagship of the NZAC hut network.
- Unwin is the most well utilised hut we own.
- As a 48 bunk facility in a unique location with a long term concession from DOC, Unwin holds much unrealised potential to deliver such things as accommodation and outdoor education to school groups, and higher skills instruction to the outdoor community.
- We cannot 'do nothing' as the facility is badly in need of repair. Reducing the size of the facility would not result in any significant savings and would ultimately restrict it's future potential

The Wellington Section committee has considered this request at length and have concluded that the Wellington Section can and should contribute \$20,000 as a loan to the NZAC to be put towards the Unwin Project. The purpose of the article that follows is to inform members of the case behind this decision the committee is about to make.

Unwin Project Funding Plan

The overall funding plan for the Unwin Project as shown below requires Sections to collectively contribute up to \$100,000 towards the project:

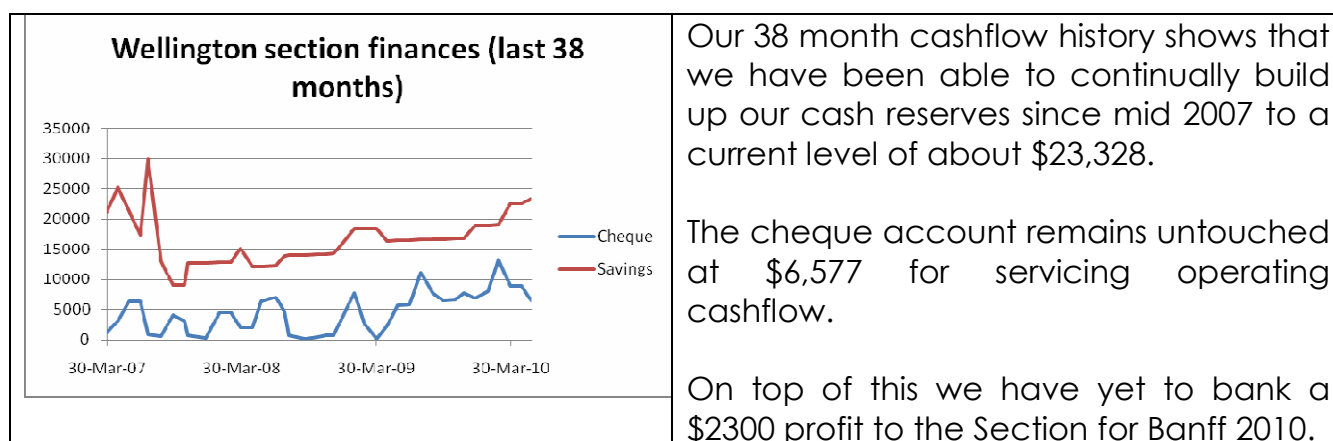
Contribution from Hut Reserve Fund	\$100,000
Loan from Canterbury Community Trust	\$100,000
Loans from Members	\$200,000
Contributions from Sections	\$100,000
Contributions from Future Income (next 2 years)	\$100,000

TOTAL \$600,000

Across the eleven Sections of the NZAC it is estimated that there is about \$120,000 of cash reserve sitting in the various Section bank accounts. It is felt that the more that can be raised within existing Club reserves the less overall cost and risk there will be to the Club as a whole.

Potential Contribution from Wellington Section

The Wellington Section Committee has reviewed the Section's financial position and concludes that the Section could afford to contribute \$20,000 towards the Unwin Project. This would still leave the Section with a reasonable cash balance to provide operating capital and maintain solvency.



Our annual financial performance since 2004 demonstrates our ability to return annual surpluses every year in order to build up cash reserves:

Year	Annual Turnover	Net Surplus	Comment
2004	\$37,496	\$6,756	
2005	\$36,601	(\$995)	But includes a \$5,620 donation as expenditure
2006	\$37,118	\$2,428	
2007	\$40,067	(\$4511)	But includes \$6,000 forgiveness of loan to NZAC
2008	\$53,277	\$1,918	
2009	\$25,378	\$4,353	Banff turnover handled by NZAC HQ in 2009

Figures derived from Annual Financial Statements 2004 to 2009

Terms of the Loan to the Club

The proposed terms for the loan are:

- Interest free but indexed against the CPI
- Serviced over the next ten years
- Lump sum repayments on application

Risks to the Section

Risk	Chance	Impact	Mitigation
The Section gets into financial trouble	Low	High	- Can apply for lump sum repayment on the loan - NZAC will underwrite the Section's financial obligations - Section to run annual surpluses in order to build

			up reserves again
The Section needs money for a local project or initiative; fund an expedition, replacement of equipment, build or purchase a local climbing facility	Med	Med	- Can apply for lump sum repayment on the loan - Section to run annual surpluses in order to build up reserves again - Run local fund raising events e.g lectures, film festivals - Apply for community grants
NZAC defaults on the loan	Low	Med	- Section to reduce dependence on loan repayment by running annual surpluses in order to build up reserves again
The Section has an accident and is sued	Low	High	- The NZAC already carries Public Indemnity Insurance - Carry insurance for any hired vehicles

Other considerations

Wellington Section has provided the Club with loans before. One was ultimately forgiven in 2007 as the Section no longer needed the cash.

The Committee is currently putting together a gear replacement programme to ensure this can be budgeted for in future years. The Committee does not foresee any other projects or initiatives that would place a demand on our reserves. Neither have we had any projects or initiatives in the last five years.

Conclusions

The Committee supports the proposal for the following reasons:

- It provides an opportunity for us to put our existing cash reserve to good use within acceptable levels of risk. Also we have done it before.
- It makes more economic sense for the Club to use existing reserves ahead of borrowing
- The Unwin Project fits within the strategic goals of the Club and is good for the Club
- Loaning the money (instead of gifting) enforces a discipline that ensures the Club as a whole preserves its capital
- The Wellington Section has a proven ability in re-building its cash reserves. This will mitigate against tying up our reserves in the form of a 10 year loan to the Club

Even though these are the conclusions that we as a committee have come to we would welcome any other thoughts that our members may have for our consideration. Please feel free to submit any feedback to me before 31st July 2010 at jw@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz or write to:

The Secretary
 NZAC Wellington Section
 P.O. Box 1628 WELLINGTON

James Wright
 Section Representative
 Wellington Section, NZAC



CLASSIFIEDS



Summer Migrant – book wanted

Cliff Peady would like to ask members if they have a copy of 'Summer Migrant the mountain writings of Nicholas Reeves' that they no longer want. If so, would they please email him cliffpeady@gmail.com



NZAC Alpine Journals for Sale

For sale - A complete set of NZAC Alpine Journals from 1947-2009. Offers – please call Ron Mundell 06 759 4332 or fax him on 06 759 4335



NOTICES



\$1000 Marmot Winter Wonderland Pack

Win a Marmot Winter Wonderland Pack, to the value of \$1000 and set yourself up for winter! The snow is here and it's the perfect time to kit yourself out for winter. Marmot's clothing range covers everything from high quality down, softshell, fleece, shell jackets and pants, skiwear, gloves, hats and kidswear. So when you head into the outdoors or around town this season you'll be prepared for anything and looking good too! Visit www.marmotnz.co.nz to register for your chance to take away \$1000 worth of Marmot gear.



Backcountry Ski / Climbing Partner

Hey my name is Rowan Frost and i will be travelling around the South Island arriving on the 11th of July until hopefully early December. I am a keen backcountry telemark skier and would love to hear from anyone looking for crew to ski with. I have my Level 1 CAA Avalanche Ticket and work as a bushwalking guide in Australia. I will be available with some notice anywhere in the South Island (Im hitching around so the more notice the better), I will be doing an 8 day Ski Mountaineering course while in NZ, i have been rock climbing for a couple of years and know basic rope work. Very very keen to learn and hear from anyone who wants a crazy aussie along on a trip! I have all required safety gear shovel, probe, beacon, harness etc. If your interested contact me via email at frosy_2086@hotmail.com or Phone: 0427035175 (Australian number) or visit my blog for this trip <http://frostydesign.blogspot.com/>



SAFE (7233) free text intentions service

The SAFE (7233) text message service is provided to anyone wishing to record their travel intentions within New Zealand. The service is provided free by Telecom, Vodafone, and 2degrees. Vodafone and 2degrees customers can also use the service overseas.

Messages are not monitored, but are stored for 12 months (Telecom and 2degrees) or for 3 months (Vodafone) and can be retrieved later on request by Police if necessary to assist in the location of a person. Messages include the date and time the message was sent. The databases store text messages only, not pxt or video.

The service is not a substitute for 111, which should always be called in an emergency.

There are no privacy implications for investigating Police requesting access to the text messages, or for Telecom, Vodafone and 2degrees providing the text messages to Police

because people using the service intend Police have access to the database as required.

From the perspective of the Telecom, Vodafone or 2degrees customer, the service appears to be integrated. However, for technical reasons Telecom, Vodafone and 2degrees maintain their own databases for messages text to SAFE (7233). Should police want to view a message left by a missing person, it is necessary to know their mobile phone number to establish whether they are with Telecom, Vodafone or 2degrees.

For more details go to <http://www.police.govt.nz/safety/safe-txt.html>



Travel Insurance – Service Charge Increase

As from August 1st, 2010 the current \$20 service charge for processing NZAC travel Insurance applications will increase to \$40.

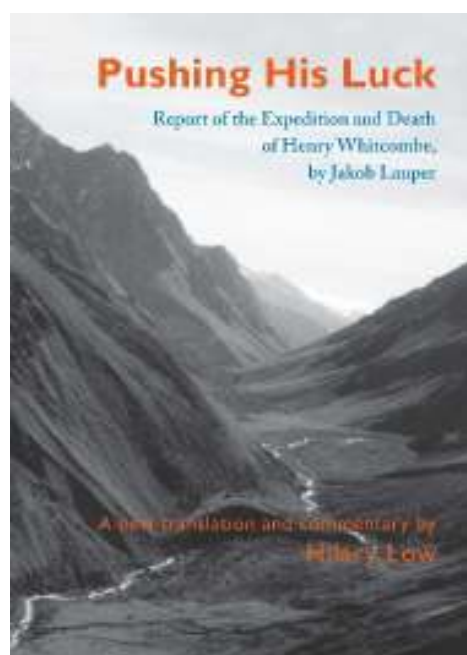


Climbs over 7000m – Insurance

Our travel insurance provider would like to gain a better understanding of the demand for insurance for climbs over 7000m. They are looking at the possibility of underwriting cover on individual consideration and depending on the degree of difficulty of the climb and the member's experience. If members that have, or are looking to, climb above this height could provide feedback on what they would want from cover, where they have climbed, difficulty of various peaks/climbs, their experience, or any other information they believe would be useful, would they please email Margaret@alpineclub.org.nz Thank you.



New Book Available From July – Pushing His Luck



The report of the Expedition and Death of Henry Whitcombe by Jakob Lauper. A new translation and commentary by Hilary Low.

We will be stocking copies of this new book, for a limited time, at a discounted member price of \$30.00 + \$4 p&p (non members \$40 + p&p). A review of this publication will be published in the Spring 'The Climber' Issue #73. Sales will become available from July 1st from the National Office and online:

<http://alpineclub.org.nz/product/pushing-his-luck>



Introduction to Back Country Skiing

Because of unforeseen demand we have now employed a third guide for the NZAC Introduction to Back Country Skiing course and there is space for two more participants.

The course is for strong intermediate skiers (or better) with good fitness who would like to learn the skills to take to the back country on their skis. The guides are NZMGA guides Nick Craddock, Al Moore, and Adrian Camm. The ratio is 1:4.

The course runs from the afternoon of Sept 5 until the afternoon of Sept 10. It's based at Mt Olympus Ski Field, and costs \$1250. This includes instruction, accommodation, food, and daily one-off lift pass for access.

For further information go to: <http://alpineclub.org.nz/default/24>



NZMGA Photo Competition now accepting entries

The annual Photo Competition is now open and we are hoping to surpass 2009 and get 1000 entries.

There is an entry form in the latest Climber, which everyone should have by now, or you can enter on line via the NZAC website. <http://alpineclub.org.nz/photocomp/2010>

You can also view the entries via the site and keep up with your competition.

Alpine Recreation, of Tekapo has put forward an Alpine Instruction Course worth \$1800 for the winner of the "youth" category. This constitutes 20 years and under on June 15, and NZAC membership isn't necessary. If you know of any keen young outdoor photographers, why not encourage them to enter. This is a great prize!

It's never been easier to enter, so be in to win \$6000 worth of prizes from Marmot, Scarpa, Image Lab, and Alpine Recreation.



Summer Instruction Programme

Details of the NZAC Summer Instruction Programme will be announced within the next few weeks. The courses in the planning are:

The Freda Du Faur Mountain Skills for Women
High Alpine Skills Course
Alpine Rock: multi-pitch rock climbing skills

Watch this space!



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\$360



\$230

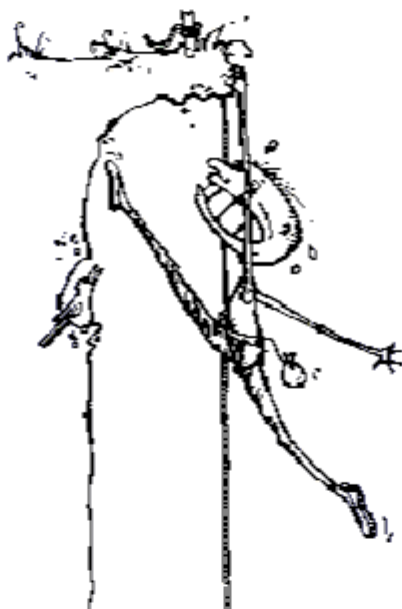


\$370



WELLINGTON SECTION: 2010/11 CONTACT LIST

Position	Name	Email alias*	Phone
Chairperson	Vacant	chairperson	
Vice Chair	Vacant	vicechair	
Secretary	Catherine Moger	secretary or CM2	04 973 1307 (h) 021 079 0854
Treasurer	Matt Knarston	treasurer	
National Rep	James Wright	JW	027 472 5561
Instruction Convenor	Don French	DF	
Trips	Kevin Patterson	Trips or KP	04 934 0975 (h) 027 687 9573
Other Committee Members	Richard Davies	RD	
	Scott Taylor	ST	
	ShiChang Hou	SH	
	Steve Minchin	SM	
	Hinrich Schaefer		
	Rebecca Thomson		
Other Roles:			
Gear	Marcus Manning	gear	
Personal Locator Beacons	Kevin Patterson	PLB or KP	
Instruction - AIC	Don French	AIC or DF	06 3777 117 (h) 027 445 2980
Instruction - Rock	Blair Hiscoke	summerrock or BH	
Library	Derek Richardson	library	
	Peter Shanahan	PS2	
Newsletter Editor	Steve Minchin	newsletter or SM	
Rock Drill overseer	Kristen Foley	drill or KF	
Website	Richard Thomson	webmaster	
* Email address is: alias@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz eg. secretary@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz			
Any membership, Distaghil Sar Fund, or general queries should be directed to the secretary			
Any media queries should be directed to:			
National Executive Officer	Ollie Clifton	ollie@alpineclub.org.nz	03 3777 595



If undelivered please return to:

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PO Box 1628
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